



Your AI Second Brain

A hands-on hour. Open your laptop — you are building this with me, not watching me build it.

BRING: A LAPTOP · CLAUDE · OBSIDIAN IF YOU HAVE IT



What you will have when you leave

Not a demo you watched. A thing on your own laptop, with your own work in it, that keeps working on Monday.

A place your work lives

Your accounts, your promises, your half-finished drafts — written once, in plain text you own, instead of re-typed into a chat window every morning.

Assistants that know your job

One per hat you wear. Each knows what it is responsible for, and — the part that matters — where it stops.

A page that will not flatter you

Rebuilt from your notes every time. It names what is waiting on you and how long it has been waiting.

Everything you build today is yours, on your own machine, and none of it needs us afterwards.



You already have a second brain. It is just in the wrong place.

Every morning you re-explain yourself

New chat, same context. Who the client is, what we agreed, how we do it here. You are the RAM, and you get wiped nightly.

The thing only you know how to do

The report, the handover, the monthly thing. It lives in your head, so it cannot be handed over and it cannot be helped with.

The drafts that never leave your notes

Written, nearly good, never posted or sent. Nothing is watching them, so nothing reminds you.

None of this is a discipline problem. There is nowhere for the answer to live that both you and an AI can read tomorrow.



This is not being built for you. It is being built for the agents.

Your vault is not a nicer set of notes. It is a structure an LLM can read, navigate and act on — written in the shape a machine needs, which happens to also be readable by a person.

ONE HOME

A fact lives in one place

So an agent never has to choose between two versions of the truth — and neither do you.

FIELDS, NOT PROSE

Every note is labelled

Plain-text fields it can filter, count and reason over, instead of guessing from prose.

THE GRAPH

Linked, never copied

The graph is how it finds context. Copy-paste breaks it; a link makes it navigable.



Obsidian: your vault, and why it is worth the five minutes

Obsidian does not store anything. It reads the folder. Most of you already have it — if you do not, you can still do every step today.

WHAT IT GIVES THE AGENTS

Retrieval that actually works

Backlinks and the graph turn your notes into something an agent can walk: from a client, to the promise, to the workflow that delivers it.

Plus the plugin shelf — Dataview and the rest — which lets a page answer a question instead of just sitting there.

IF YOU SKIP IT TODAY

Everything still works

The vault is plain Markdown. Notepad opens it, Claude reads and writes it, every step in this hour runs.

What you lose is the retrieval side: the graph links, the backlinks and the plugins. Install it tonight and nothing has to be redone.



Before we start

- **Claude, on your laptop**

The desktop app, signed in. This is where every step happens.
- **Somewhere to put a folder**

Documents is fine. It will be empty when we start.
- **Obsidian, if you have it**

Optional. Five minutes to install if you want it now — or tonight.
- **Nothing else**

No Python, no terminal, no account to create, no plugin to buy.



1 Make the folder

DO THIS NOW

Make an empty folder and name it after yourself or your team. Documents\My Second Brain is a fine answer.

You will know it worked when the folder exists and is empty. That is genuinely all of step one.

WHY A FOLDER AND NOT AN APP

Because you keep it

Everything today is plain text files in this folder. No database, no account, nothing hosted. If we never speak again it still opens — and you can read every file of it in Notepad.



2 Open it in Obsidian

DO THIS NOW

In Obsidian choose Open folder as vault, and pick the folder you just made. If you do not have Obsidian, skip this and carry on.

You will know it worked when Obsidian shows an empty vault with your folder's name in the corner.

It is now a vault

Same folder, nothing moved or converted. “Vault” is just Obsidian's word for a folder it is watching.

Leave it open beside Claude

For the rest of the hour you will watch notes appear in Obsidian as Claude writes them. That is the whole demo, really.



3

Make a project, and connect the folder

DO THIS NOW

In Claude, create a project and name it after your work. Then connect the folder you just made to that project and approve it.

You will know it worked when Claude tells you the folder is connected and can list what is in it — nothing.

WHY A PROJECT AND NOT A NORMAL CHAT

Because a project remembers

Every conversation inside it reads and writes the same folder. Next week starts where today ended instead of starting from nothing — which is the thing that has been annoying you every morning.



4

Ask for the setup

DO THIS NOW

Type the sentence below into your project. Then watch Obsidian.

You will know it worked when Claude reports back what it made — folders, a contract, agents, workflows and a page.

Set up the AI Operations Framework in my connected folder.

Pull it from github.com/meshpro/ai-ops-framework and run the install.

Or your own words — it is read for intent, not matched against a format.



Everyone should be looking at this

What needs you, and how it is running

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Waiting on you

Named, not counted — with what each one waits for and what happens if nothing is done.

Nothing is waiting on you. Everything written down has an owner and a decision.

The organisation

1 department, each with one executive who answers for it. A department with no executive, or no workflow, is named above as waiting on you.

OPERATIONS EXECUTIVE

Operations

Somebody who was away for a week can open the picture and know what happened without asking anyone.

- How work actually moves through the organisation — the workflows themselves
- The weekly rhythm: what finished, what is stale, what is next
- The standard for written work: a note somebody else could act on without asking a question

3 workflows, 1 running

Ask for it by name

“Open the picture and tell me what it says.” It is a file in your own folder.

Nearly empty, and honest

One example department, three roles. It does not pretend to be your job yet. Next step is where it becomes yours.



5 Name your hats

DO THIS NOW

Tell Claude: walk me through Setting Up a Department — my job has these parts, and then list them. Three to six.

You will know it worked when one note per hat appears in Obsidian, each with an assistant attached to it.

A DEPARTMENT IS A HAT

Not a division of the company

The accounts you look after. The reporting. The LinkedIn posting. The thing you inherited that nobody else touches. If you answer for it, it is one.

THREE TO SIX

Not twelve

If two of them would never disagree about anything, they are one hat. You can add another next week in one sentence.



Each hat says where it stops — and that matters more than what it does

THE PROBLEM

An agent always answers

Ask one something just outside its ground and it does not say “that is not mine.” It produces something confident and plausible about a subject it knows nothing about — and the answer looks exactly like a good one.

THE FIX

One line: what this is not

Your Reporting hat does not decide what to do about a bad number. Your Client Work hat does not set prices.

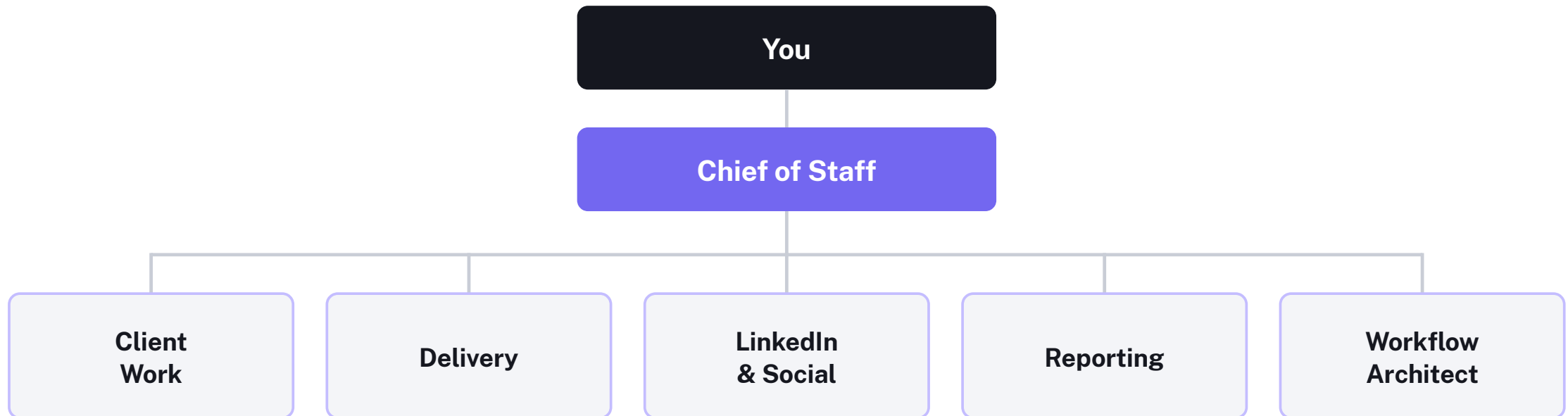
Write that down and the assistant hands the question back instead of inventing an answer.

The stop line is what makes the other answers worth having. Without it you cannot tell a good answer from a confident one — and you will find out which it was later, in front of somebody else.



That is an executive layer, and it is yours

Each hat note compiles into an assistant that answers for that hat and nothing else. Adding one next month is the same sentence again.



Four of them are your hats. The fifth keeps the writing itself honest.



Your hats, on the page, counted

Nobody typed these numbers. They were counted off your own notes when the page was built.

CLIENT WORK LEAD

Client Work

I can answer where any account stands without opening my inbox.

- The accounts on my list — who they are, what they are waiting for, what I said last
- Every promise I have made to one of them, and whether it happened

1 workflow, 0 running

DELIVERY LEAD

Delivery

Nothing is late without me having said so first.

- Everything in flight, with the date I said it would land
- The handover: what somebody needs to pick a piece up from me

1 workflow, 1 running

LINKEDIN & SOCIAL LEAD

LinkedIn & Social

A month's posts can be listed without scrolling anywhere.

- What goes out, when, and in whose voice
- The half-written drafts that never make it out of my notes

1 workflow, 0 running

“LinkedIn & Social — 1 workflow, 0 running.” Uncomfortable, true, and you did not have to admit it.



6

Write down the thing that annoys you most

DO THIS NOW

Say: let's write down how [the thing] actually happens today, including the parts that are a mess. Then answer its questions.

You will know it worked when a workflow note exists with your steps in it — marked as a draft, and as not yet running.

PICK BADLY ON PURPOSE**Not your most important process**

The one that goes wrong most often. That is where an assistant earns its place, and it is the one you will actually check.

TWO MARKS, NOT ONE**Written down is not working**

Is the note true? Only after you have walked one real case through it. Does it run end to end? Different question. They fail separately, so they are tracked separately.



It tells you when you are wrong

A hat with no assistant, and a workflow pointing at a hat that does not exist — a typo. Three seconds later:

FAILED: every department has exactly one executive who answers for it —
'Reporting' has no executive; every question about it lands back on you

FAILED: every workflow belongs somewhere — 'Posting on LinkedIn' belongs to
'LinkedIn and Socail', and there is no note by that name

No error code, no line number. It names the note and says what it costs you. That is why the page is still true in a month.

What to do with it next week

- **Open the project, not a new chat**

That is the whole habit. Everything else follows from it.

- **Add the hat you forgot today**

You will think of it on Tuesday. One sentence.

- **Write down the second annoying thing**

One a week is a transformed job by Christmas.

- **Ask it what is waiting on you**

On Friday. It will tell you, and it will be right.

It is your folder, on your laptop. Nothing here phones home.